

What the app costs to run

A plain-English guide to every service behind the app: what it does, what's free, and when you'd start paying.

Prepared September 2026. Prices change, so check each service's pricing page (listed at the end) before you pay for anything.

The short version

\$25

one time: Google Play developer account

\$0 / month

today: every service is on its free plan

\$10–50 / month

typical once the app and newsletter grow

- Right now the app costs **nothing per month**. Every service it uses has a free plan big enough for launch.
- Costs start only when (1) the **newsletter list gets big**, (2) **lots of people use the app**, or (3) you **switch on paid extras** such as text messages (SMS) or iPhone.
- **Sermons and live services cost you nothing extra**. Audio streams from Podbean and video from YouTube, so they don't use your paid services.
- **Giving and book sales are commission-free for the app**. People pay through PayPal, Cash App, MoMo, the bank or Amazon. Google and Apple take no cut. Those payment services charge their own usual fees on each transaction.

First limit you're likely to reach: the email daily limit. Brevo's free plan sends **300 emails a day**, and that includes sign-up codes. Once more than about 250 people subscribe by email, a newsletter to everyone would stop partway. Before that happens, move Brevo to its Starter plan (about \$9/month; see Brevo below). The Owner dashboard shows the subscriber count, so you can watch for it.

How each charge works

Google Play Console \$25 once

What it's for: publishing the Android app on the Play Store.

How you pay: a single \$25 registration fee. There's no yearly fee. Google takes no commission because the app sells nothing through Google Play.

Apple Developer Program Later: \$99 / year

What it's for: publishing the iPhone app on the App Store. We agreed to wait on this.

How you pay: \$99 every year, as long as the app is on the App Store. If you stop paying, the app is removed from the store.

Supabase: the backend

Free now

Pro \$25 / month

What it's for: accounts and sign-in, newsletter subscribers, announcements and flyers, the content you edit in the dashboard (books, perfumes, quotes...), photos you upload, and the functions that send newsletters.

	Free plan	Pro plan (\$25/month)
Monthly active users (people who sign in)	50,000	100,000, then about \$0.003 each
Database (text data)	500 MB	8 GB, then about \$0.125 per GB
File storage (flyers, covers, perfume photos)	1 GB	100 GB, then about \$0.02 per GB
Bandwidth (photos and data sent to phones)	5 GB / month	250 GB, then about \$0.09 per GB
Function calls (sending newsletters, AI drafts)	500,000 / month	2 million / month
Backups	None	Daily, kept 7 days
Pausing	Pauses after 7 days with no activity	Never pauses

What these mean for The AFM HUB:

- **Database:** text is tiny. 500 MB holds hundreds of thousands of subscribers and announcements, so you won't reach it for years.
- **Storage:** a phone photo is about 0.3–1 MB, so 1 GB holds roughly 1,000–3,000 flyers and product photos.
- **Bandwidth** is the one that grows with popularity. Every time a phone downloads a flyer or cover, it counts. The app keeps images it has already shown, so repeat views don't count again. *Example:* 2,000 people each seeing 2 new flyers a week at 0.5 MB each is about 8 GB a month. That's over the free 5 GB, and the point where Pro makes sense.
- **Pausing:** a free project pauses after 7 days with nobody using it. Once the app has daily users, it stays awake. If it does pause, press "Restore" in the Supabase dashboard.

No surprise bills: the Pro plan has a spend cap switched on by default. You pay \$25, and at the plan limits usage is restricted instead of billed extra, unless you turn the cap off.

Brevo: email

Free now

Starter from about \$9 / month

What it's for: newsletters and announcements by email, plus account emails (sign-up codes and password resets).

Plan	Emails	Price (approx.)
Free	300 per day (about 9,000 a month), with a small Brevo logo in emails	\$0
Starter	5,000 per month, no daily limit	about \$9 / month
Starter	20,000 per month	about \$25–30 / month
Starter	100,000 per month	about \$65–75 / month

How to work out your plan: email subscribers × newsletters per month.

Example: 1,000 email subscribers × 4 newsletters a month = 4,000 emails, so the \$9 plan is enough.
3,000 subscribers × 4 = 12,000 emails, so choose the 20,000 plan.

Tip: for the most reliable delivery, send from an address on the ministry's own domain rather than a Gmail address (see "Domain" below).

Text messages (SMS) through Twilio

Not switched on

Pay per text

What it's for: announcements by text, and signing in with a phone code. Both are built but switched off until you choose to pay for them.

How you pay: you top up credit and each text uses some. A long message can count as 2 texts.
Approximate prices per text:

Sending to	Approx. price per text	Notes
Ghana	\$0.20 – \$0.35	International rates are high for Ghana
United Kingdom	\$0.04 – \$0.06	
United States	about \$0.01 + carrier fees	Needs a one-time business registration (about \$20–50) and a number (about \$1–2/month)

Example: 500 subscribers in Ghana × 4 announcements a month = 2,000 texts, which is about **\$400–700 a month**.

Recommendation: SMS is by far the most expensive part. **App push notifications are free and unlimited**, and email is cheap, so lean on those. If you want texts in Ghana, local bulk-SMS companies usually charge a small fraction of Twilio's price. The app can be switched to one with a small change; just ask.

Expo (EAS): app builds and push notifications Free

What it's for: building the Android (and later iPhone) app files, and delivering push notifications.

How you pay: the free plan includes about 30 builds a month (usually you need 1–3). Builds wait in a queue, which is why a build can take 10–30 minutes. **Push notifications are free and unlimited.** Paid plans (from about \$19/month) only make builds faster. You don't need one.

Anthropic (Claude AI) Optional Pay as you go

What it's for: the "Write it with AI" button in the Owner dashboard, and optionally the online AI assistant.

How you pay: you buy prepaid credit (minimum about \$5) and each use takes a little. One AI-written announcement costs a few US cents, so \$5 lasts a long time. The AFM Assistant in the app currently answers from the app's own content for free. Switching on the fully online assistant would cost roughly a cent or a few cents per question, depending on the AI model chosen.

Hosting the online assistant: Cloudflare Workers is free up to 100,000 requests a day.

Domain name and ministry email Optional about \$10–20 / year

What it's for: a web address like *theafmhub.org*. It gives you a home for the privacy policy, better newsletter delivery (for example *news@theafmhub.org*), and a more professional look.

How you pay: yearly renewal. A mailbox on the domain (for example Google Workspace) is optional, at about \$7 per person per month.

Podbean, YouTube, PayPal, MoMo, Amazon Nothing new

The app only links to or reads from these, so it adds no cost. Any Podbean plan the ministry already pays stays the same. PayPal, Cash App, MoMo and banks charge their normal fees on each gift. Amazon handles book payments and pays royalties as usual.

What you'd pay as the ministry grows

Stage	Roughly	Monthly cost	What you'd be paying for
Launch (now)	Up to a few hundred users, under 250 email subscribers	\$0	Everything on free plans (plus the one-time \$25 Google fee)
Growing	1,000–3,000 users, 500–2,000 email subscribers, weekly newsletter	\$10–50	Brevo Starter (\$9–25), and Supabase Pro (\$25) once photo bandwidth passes 5 GB
Established	10,000+ users, 5,000+ email subscribers	\$50–100	Supabase Pro (\$25 + small extras), Brevo (\$25–75)
Any stage: extras		varies	SMS (per text), AI (cents per use), Apple (\$99/year), domain (\$10–20/year)

How to stay in control

- **Check usage monthly.** Supabase: Project → *Usage*. Brevo: *Dashboard* shows emails sent and your plan limit.
- **Watch the newsletter results.** If the Owner dashboard shows emails as "failed", the most likely cause is Brevo's free daily limit. Upgrade Brevo, then send again.
- **Keep Supabase's spend cap on** (it's on by default on Pro), so the bill never goes above the plan price.
- **Set billing alerts or email notifications** on each service with a card attached.
- **Account ownership:** today everything is under princeanim88@gmail.com. When the ministry email is available, add it to each service as an owner or admin, and move billing to the ministry's card if that's the plan.

Pricing pages to check

Service	Where to check prices
Supabase	supabase.com/pricing
Brevo	brevo.com/pricing
Twilio SMS	twilio.com/en-us/sms/pricing (choose the country)
Expo EAS	expo.dev/pricing
Anthropic	claude.com/pricing (API section)
Google Play / Apple	play.google.com/console · developer.apple.com/programs

All figures are approximate, in US dollars, and based on published prices known as of 2026. Card payments in other currencies may include bank conversion fees.